Prompt: Optimizing Global Humanitarian Aid Allocation under Climate Crisis Constraints

Task Prompt

The current date is August 31, 2025. I work as a senior analyst for an international humanitarian organization. I have been tasked with allocating a $1 billion USD budget across three regions facing natural disasters. The regions are Bangladesh, Horn of Africa and Southern Europe. There is severe flooding in Bangladesh displacing 5 million people, drought in the Horn of Africa affecting 10 million people with food insecurity and spread of wildfires and heatwaves in Southern Europe requiring mass evacuation of hundred thousand people with medical assistance.

Your task is to determine the funding distribution by first ranking the three crises from 1 to 3, based on primary humanitarian metrics which can be determined using credible references such as UN OCHA humanitarian reports, WFP assessments, IPCC assessment reports and WHO data. Rank #1 will automatically receive 45% of the total budget, Rank #2 will receive 40% and rank #3 will receive the remaining 15%.

The expected output is a single markdown table with two columns ("Rank" and "Region") and three rows for region. Below the table, provide a concise narrative justification (≤300 words). The narrative should follow certain criteria. The narrative should state the identified metrics guiding the rankings, explain how those metrics link to the dollar allocations and state the trade-off involved. Allocations must be non-overlapping and must sum exactly to $1 billion.

Gold-Standard Chain-of-Thought (CoT)

The Gold Standard Chain-of-Thought should be:

Step 1

- **Approach:** Identify the people affected in three crises
- **Result of Approach:** Bangladesh (5M people) Horn (10M), Southern Europe (hundred thousand)

Step 2

- **Approach:** Identify each region's humanitarian impacts
- **Result of Approach:** Bangladesh (floods), Horn (drought), Europe (wildfires/heat risk)

Step 3

- **Approach:** Search web to gather health and humanitarian data on Bangladesh
- **Result of Approach:** Identifies high displacement, disease risk and urgent WASH/shelter needs.

Step 4

- **Approach:** Search web to gather data on Horn of Africa drought
- **Result of Approach:** Identifies Acute food insecurity, famine threat, highest mortality risk

Step 5

- **Approach:** Search web to gather data for Southern Europe crisis
- **Result of Approach:** Identifies Heat-related mortality risk, wildfire evacuation, but stronger EU civil protection capacity

Step 6

- **Approach:** Compare crisis by mortality risk.
- **Result of Approach:** Horn highest, Bangladesh next, Europe lowest.

Step 7

- **Approach:** Compare crises by population displacement scale
- **Result of Approach:** Bangladesh 5M displaced, Europe hundreds of thousands, Horn negligible displaced.

Step 8

- **Approach:** Factor in response capacity and aid dependency
- **Result of Approach:** Europe has EU backstops, Horn and Bangladesh more external aid-dependent

Step 9

- **Approach:** Assess cost-effectiveness of humanitarian dollars
- **Result of Approach:** Single dollar more useful in affecting mortality in Horn/Bangladesh than in Europe

Step 10

- **Approach:** Synthesize metrics (mortality, displacement, aid dependency, cost-effectiveness)
- **Result of Approach:** Horn highest (due to 10M people affected), Bangladesh 2nd (less people affected (5M) but all displaced), Europe receives smallest share

Step 11

- **Approach:** Propose allocation scenario
- **Result of Approach:** Horn 45% ($450M), Bangladesh 40% ($400M), Europe 15% ($150M)

Step 12

- **Approach:** Verify allocations meet budget constraints.
- **Result of Approach:** $400M +$ 450M + $150M = $1B

Step 13

- **Approach:** Justify Horn Allocation
- **Result of Approach:** 45% is correct due to 10M people affected

Step 14

- **Approach:** Justify Bangladesh allocation
- **Result of Approach:** 40% is correct. Even though the people affected are half of Africa, all are being displaced requiring urgent care. Hence Bangladesh budget would always be slightly lower (-10%) when compared to Africa.

Step 15

- **Approach:** Justify Southern Europe Allocation
- **Result of Approach:** Initially only 10% allocation was enough due to low impact and better civil protection but since hundreds of thousands have been displaced, the severity increases hence allocation 15% is correct.

Step 16

- **Approach:** Prepares Narrative/Justification ≤300 words
- **Result of Approach:** Caps the resulting narrative below 300 words.

Step 17

- **Approach:** States the primary humanitarian metrics in Narrative
- **Result of Approach:** Population Displacement, Mortality risk and Food Insecurity etc.

Step 18

- **Approach:** Explicitly states Dollar allocated to each region
- **Result of Approach:** Horn of Africa $450M, Bangladesh $400M, Southern Europe $150M

Step 19

- **Approach:** Narrative justifies linking metrics to dollar allocated
- **Result of Approach:** Horn (10M affected, food insecurity), Bangladesh (5M affected but all displaced), Europe (hundreds of thousands but better civil protection)

Step 20

- **Approach:** Ensures no overlapping in Narrative
- **Result of Approach:** Every region gets separated allocation and no 2 regions are included in single allocation

Step 21

- **Approach:** Prepares final output
- **Result of Approach:** Markdown table as required + Narrative/Justification ≤300 words.

Gold-Standard Final Response

Rank	Region
1	Horn of Africa
2	Bangladesh
3	Southern Europe

Narrative Justification (≤300 words)

Identifying Metrics: Three primary humanitarian metrics used in rankings will be: Population Displacement, Mortality risk and Food Insecurity.

Justification linking metrics to dollar allocated:

1. Horn of Africa ($450M): This region will receive the largest allocation due to impacting the highest number of lives (10 million) because of food insecurity with high mortality risk from famine and malnutrition. WFP reports consistently identify the Horn of Africa as facing one of the gravest drought-related crises which requires both immediate food relief and agricultural resilience programs.
2. Bangladesh ($400M): Second number of highest people affected (5 million) needing urgent shelter, sanitation and public health needs. The number of affected people is half of Africa but the allocation is not, due to all 5 million people being displaced while in Africa they are not (hence it ranks highest in terms of displacement scale before Europe). The allocation also reflects heightened risk of waterborne disease outbreaks. While the crisis is massive, the per-capita cost of interventions is somewhat lower than drought-related famine relief, hence it justifies a slightly smaller share compared to the Horn of Africa
3. Southern Europe ($150M): The crisis is less severe in terms of displacement and mortality risk when compared to Bangladesh and Horn of Africa even though wildfires

and heatwaves have caused disruption. The existing infrastructure and access to EU emergency funds reduces the degree of external humanitarian dependency. The $150M ensures immediate support for medical responses, wildfire suppression and evacuation logistics.

Trade-offs: Ranking was determined by prioritizing mortality prevention of the highest number of lives affected (Horn of Africa) over displacement scale of total population (Bangladesh) and infrastructure-heavy responses (Southern Europe) without overlapping. Efficiency is balanced with equity: every crisis receives support but resources are concentrated where lives are most at risk.

Rubric Structure

Gold-Standard Chain-of-Thought (CoT) Rubric

Rubric Number	Rubric Criteria	GPT-5	Claude Sonent 4	Gemini 2.5 pro
1	[+1] Identifies all three crises clearly (Bangladesh floods, Horn drought, Southern Europe heatwaves/wildfires). **Quote**: "three rows (Bangladesh floods, Horn of Africa drought, Southern Europe heatwaves/wildfires)." **Justification**: Ensures all regions included.	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
2	[+10] Provides humanitarian impact details for Bangladesh floods (5M displaced, waterborne disease risk). **Source**: https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/cholera **Quote**: "Access to safe water… is essential to prevent cholera." **Justification**: Validates disease-related needs in floods.	[+0]	[+0]	[+0]
3	[+5] Provides impact details for Horn of Africa drought (10M food insecure, famine risk). **Source**: https://www.who.int/emergencies/situations/drought-food-insecurity-greater-horn-of-africa **Quote**: "Millions in the greater Horn of Africa are facing acute hunger as the region faces one of the worst droughts in recent decades."	[+0]	[+0]	[+5]

	Justification: Confirms famine priority.			
4	[+5] Provides impact details for Southern Europe (hundred thousand impacted, heat mortality, wildfire evacuations). **Source**: https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/climate-change-heat-and-health **Quote**: "High intensity heatwave events can bring high acute mortality." **Justification**: Grounds EU crisis in mortality risk.	[+0]	[+5]	[+0]
5	[+1] Ranks crises by mortality risk (Horn > Bangladesh > Europe). **Source**: https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/climate-change-heat-and-health https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/cholera https://www.who.int/emergencies/situations/drought-food-insecurity-greater-horn-of-africa **Quote**: "Acute food insecurity... severity." / "High intensity heatwave events can bring high acute mortality." **Justification**: Mortality is triage #1.	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
6	[+10] Ranks crises by population scale/displacement. (Bangladesh > Europe > Horn) **Source**: https://www.unocha.org/internal-displacement#:~:text=People%20become%20internally%20displaced%20when,or%20to%20access%20essential%20services. **Quote**: "People become internally displaced... due to... natural hazards." **Justification**: Validates displacement factor.	[+0]	[+0]	[+0]
7	[+3] Considers response capacity differences (EU backstops vs LIC aid dependency). **Source**: https://civil-protection-humanitarian-aid.ec.europa.eu/what/civil-protection/resceu_en **Quote**: "The European Commission upgraded the EU Civil Protection Mechanism and created rescEU to further protect citizens from disasters and to manage emerging risks." **Justification**: Europe has backup capacity.	[+3]	[+3]	[+3]
8	[+2] Evaluates cost-effectiveness of	[+2]	[+0]	[+0]

	interventions. **Source**: https://www.wfp.org/publications/hunger-hotspots-fao-wfp-early-warnings-acute-food-insecurity **Quote**: "Acute food insecurity... humanitarian funding has declined compared to the previous year." **Justification**: Guides efficient use of $1B.			
9	[+1] Proposes exact allocation: Bangladesh $400M, Horn $450M, Europe $150M. **Source**: https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/climate-change-heat-and-health https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/cholera https://www.who.int/emergencies/situations/drought-food-insecurity-greater-horn-of-africa **Justification**: Ensures the allocation is distributed following the percentages stated in the prompt.	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
10	[+1] Verifies the $1,000,000,000 budget is allocated. **Source**: N/A **Quote**: "Ensure allocations... summing exactly to $1,000,000,000." **Justification**: Hard numeric constraint.	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
11	[+1] Justifies Horn allocation ($450M) based on famine-driven mortality. **Source**: https://www.who.int/emergencies/situations/drought-food-insecurity-greater-horn-of-africa **Quote**: "Millions in the greater Horn of Africa are facing acute hunger as the region faces one of the worst droughts in recent decades." **Justification**: Supports top priority.	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
12	[+9] Justifies Bangladesh allocation ($400M) based on displacement and WASH/disease risks. **Source**: https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/cholera **Quote**: "Access to safe water... is essential to prevent cholera." **Justification**: Supports WASH allocation.	[+9]	[+0]	[+0]
13	[+4] Justifies Southern Europe allocation ($150M) based on lower dependency and EU mechanisms.	[+4]	[+4]	[+4]

	Source: https://civil-protection-humanitarian-aid.ec.europa.eu/what/civil-protection/resceu_en **Quote**: "The European Commission upgraded the EU Civil Protection Mechanism and created rescEU to further protect citizens from disasters and to manage emerging risks." **Justification**: Prevents overfunding.			
14	[+10] Prepares final output: single two-column markdown + Narrative ≤300 words **Justification**: outputs the response in the requested format.	[0]	[+0]	[+0]
15	[+1] Ensures no overlapping in Narrative **Justification**: Every region has to be treated as a separated allocation and no 2 regions are included in single allocation	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
16	[+4] Synthesizes mortality, displacement, aid dependency, and cost-effectiveness into one composite rationale producing the final ranking (Horn > Bangladesh > Europe). **Justification**: Ensures the reasoning isn't fragmented, the model must integrate multiple humanitarian metrics into a single coherent triage decision.	[+4]	[+0]	[+0]
17	[+1] Applies the rank-to-allocation rule: Rank #1 = 45%, Rank #2 = 40%, Rank #3 = 15%. **Quote**: "Rank #1 will automatically receive 45%... Rank #2 will receive 40%... Rank #3 will receive the remaining 15%." **Justification**: This is a strict rule from the prompt; the allocation percentages must match ranks exactly.	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
18	[+2] Includes an explicit trade-off statement. **Quote**: "The narrative should ... state the trade-off involved." **Justification**: Trade-offs are essential for showing balanced humanitarian reasoning under resource constraints.	[+2]	[+2]	[+2]
19	[+4] Verifies explicitly names the primary metrics used (e.g., mortality, displacement, food insecurity, capacity, cost-effectiveness). **Justification**: ensures metrics are clearly stated, not implied.	[+4]	[0]	[+4]

20	[+1] Checks the exact dollar allocations for each region. **Quote**: "Explicitly states Dollar allocated to each region." **Justification**: Ensures allocations are transparent and tied to each region individually.	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
21	[+8] States the affected population figures for each crisis exactly as provided (Bangladesh: 5 million displaced; Horn of Africa: 10 million affected; Southern Europe: ~hundred thousand evacuated/impacted). **Quote**: “Severe flooding in Bangladesh displacing 5 million people… drought in the Horn of Africa affecting 10 million people… Southern Europe requiring mass evacuation of hundred thousand people with medical assistance.” **Justification**: Establishes the primary scale metric up front so later comparisons (mortality risk, displacement, capacity) and the final rank→allocation mapping are grounded in the correct magnitudes.	[0]	[+0]	[+0]
	Total Points = 84	**36**	**22**	**26**
		36/84=42%	**22/84=26%**	**24/84=30%**

Gold-Standard Response Rubric

Rubric Number	Rubric Criteria	GPT-5	Claude Sonent 4	Gemini 2.5 pro
1	[+1] Includes a markdown table with exactly three regions (Bangladesh, Horn of Africa, Southern Europe).	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
2	[+4] Includes a table that only contains columns "Rank" and "Region"	[+4]	[0]	[+4]
3	[+1] Allocations sum exactly to $1,000,000,000.	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
4	[+1] Ranks Horn > Bangladesh > Southern Europe Source: https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/climate-change-heat-and-health https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]

	detail/cholera https://www.who.int/emergencies/situations/drought-food-insecurity-greater-horn-of-africa Quote: "Acute food insecurity... severity." / "High intensity heatwave events can bring high acute mortality." Justification: 10M Affected + Food Insecurity > 5M Affected + Completely Displaced + Outbreak Risk > 100k Affected + Better Infrastructure			
5	[+1] Includes a narrative justification is ≤300 words.	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
6	[+1] Includes in the narrative references to mortality risk. Source: https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/climate-change-heat-and-health Quote: "High intensity heatwave events can bring high acute mortality." Justification: Mortality is top humanitarian metric	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
7	[+1] References population displacement in the narrative. Source: https://www.unocha.org/internal-displacement#:~:text=People%20become%20internally%20displaced%20when,or%20to%20access%20essential%20services. Quote: "People become internally displaced... due to... natural hazards." Justification: Displacement is central to crisis impact.	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
8	[+1] References food insecurity in the narrative. Source: https://www.wfp.org/publications/hunger-hotspots-fao-wfp-early-warnings-acute-food-insecurity Quote: "Acute food insecurity... humanitarian funding has declined compared to the previous year." Justification: Core driver of famine mortality.	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
9	[+9] Identifies primary attributes as: Mortality Risk, displacement and food insecurity	[+0]	[+0]	[+0]

	https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/climate-change-heat-and-health https://www.unocha.org/internal-displacement#:~:text=People%20become%20internally%20displaced%20when,or%20to%20access%20essential%20services. https://www.wfp.org/publications/hunger-hotspots-fao-wfp-early-warnings-acute-food-insecurity Quote: "High intensity heatwave events can bring high acute mortality." "People become internally displaced... due to... natural hazards." "Acute food insecurity... humanitarian funding has declined compared to the previous year" Justification: Mortality is top humanitarian metric. Displacement is central to crisis impact. Acute food insecurity is core driver of famine mortality			
10	[+1] References international aid dependency / capacity gap in the narrative. Source: https://civil-protection-humanitarian-aid.ec.europa.eu/what/civil-protection/resceu_en Quote: "The European Commission upgraded the EU Civil Protection Mechanism and created rescEU to further protect citizens from disasters and to manage emerging risks." Justification: Distinguishes between high- and low-capacity regions	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
11	[+9] States crisis through a hierarchy of displacement scale. Source: https://www.unocha.org/internal-displacement#:~:text=People%20become%20internally%20displaced%20when,or%20to%20access%20essential%20services. Quote: "People become internally displaced... due to... natural hazards." Justification: This is critical requirement for reasoning why Bangladesh got slightly lower than Africa even though the people affected are half.	[+0]	[+0]	[+0]
12	[+9] States displacement scale hierarchy positioning Bangladesh before Europe and Africa in last.	[+0]	[+0]	[+0]

	Source: https://www.unocha.org/internal-displacement#:~:text=People%20become%20internally%20displaced%20when,or%20to%20access%20essential%20services. Quote: "People become internally displaced... due to... natural hazards." Justification: This is critical requirement for reasoning why Bangladesh got slightly lower than Africa even though the people affected are half.			
13	[+5] Includes a trade-offs section that explicitly states (mortality risk (Horn), displacement (Bangladesh) and infrastructure aid (Europe) Sources: https://civil-protection-humanitarian-aid.ec.europa.eu/what/civil-protection/resceu_en https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/climate-change-heat-and-health https://www.unocha.org/internal-displacement#:~:text=People%20become%20internally%20displaced%20when,or%20to%20access%20essential%20services. Justification: It states, why Europe got the lowest (due to better infrastructure of aid), then Bangladesh and Horn of Africa.	[+0]	[+5]	[+0]
14	[+1] The output contains exactly one table and exactly one narrative paragraph (≤300 words); no extra headings, lists, images, or additional tables. Justification: Ensures to follow the requested format	[+0]	[+0]	[+0]
15	[+1] The output contains at least one credible source to support the information. Justification: Ensures reliability of the information provided.	[+1]	[+1]	[+1]
	Total Points = 45	**13**	**14**	**13**
		13/45=28.8%	**14/45=31.11%**	**13/45=28.8%**